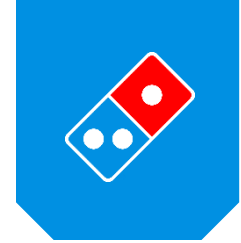


OVEN CERTIFICATION PROGRAM

Frequently Asked Questions – Published July 2026



- **Why is DPZ launching an Oven Certification Program?**
 - As a brand we want to drive product consistency by aligning all ovens to the standard customers expect. The Oven Certification Program ensures all ovens are aligned to the Product Standards, while ensuring franchisees are able to calibrate and maintain ovens to deliver our Most Delicious Food promise on every order.
- **Who will perform the Oven Certification Visit?**
 - Operations Assessment Specialists will be conducting the visits. These visits will be standalone from Ops Assessment visits.
- **What will happen during the Oven Certification Visit?**
 - Ops Specialists will be collecting data on the oven make, model, and settings, as well as the condition of the oven. They will be conducting bake tests of 4 products on each oven deck in the store to ensure the oven is producing an acceptable end bake while maintaining food safety standards.
- **Will visits be announced?**
 - All oven visits will be announced 2 weeks in advance, with a reminder 48 hours prior to the visit.
- **When should I expect an Oven Visit?**
 - Every Franchisee will receive at least 1 visit in 2026. All stores will receive an Oven Certification Visit by the end of Q1 2027.
- **Who should attend?**
 - Franchisees, above-store management, all store team members, etc. are encouraged to attend the Oven Certification Visit to observe the process, ask questions, and be ready to conduct Self-Oven Certifications in the future.
- **What products are being graded?**
 - Every oven deck will be calibrated on:
 - 14" Hand Tossed Pepperoni Pizza
 - Buffalo Chicken Sandwich
 - Pan Hawaiian Pizza
 - 14" Thin Crust Cheese
 - If the oven deck needs to be calibrated, stores may be asked to make an additional 14" HT Pepperoni and Buffalo Chicken Sandwich to determine if calibration to standards was successful. Estimated food cost is between \$12-\$18 per oven deck.
- **What is the new bake scale?**
 - The new bake scale is a color gradient tool developed by the Product Development team to assign a bake color rating to multiple product attributes. Our 5 core characteristics that make a great pizza (Rim, Size, Portion, Placement, Bake) will not change. This bake scale is an additional layer that allows us to dig deeper to align product bake quality with customer expectations.

- **Will the bake scale be added to the Ops Assessment?**
 - There will be no changes to the Ops Assessment regarding bake color for 2026. Any changes for the 2027 Operations Assessment will be announced in Q4.
- **Why is the Buffalo Chicken Sandwich graded to 170°F (77°C) when the Standard required end bake temperature is 165°F (74° C)?**
 - The 170°F (77°C) threshold is only used for the Oven Certification visit. The Buffalo Chicken Sandwich acts as a sample of the entire menu- if it can achieve an end bake temperature of 170°F (77°C) we reduce the risk of temperature failure in other products. The Product Standards for End Bake Temperature outside of the Oven Certification Visit will remain unchanged.
- **What can I do to prepare?**
 - Review the materials on the Oven Certification PieNet page. Be sure the store and ovens are prepared for the visit by reviewing and ensuring the following conditions are met:
 - Ovens set to minimum oven time and temperatures as according to Product Standards
 - All food items are maintaining minimum food safety temperatures
 - Cleanliness of oven and bake equipment
 - Correct Oven finger configuration for the oven's specific make and model
 - Oven is functioning and in good condition (address any heat related issues, gas supply, broken parts, in need of maintenance, etc.)
 - Store has properly proofed dough and ingredients at the ideal temperatures
- **What if I don't pass?**
 - If after adjustments an oven cannot produce food safe product or is producing product rated a 1 or a 5 on the gradient tool, the Ops Assessment Specialist will escalate the visit to the Business Consultant and additional follow up with the region will occur.
- **Do I need to change my PULSE oven time settings?**
 - If oven time is changed, make sure to adjust in PULSE. To identify the correct time to enter into PULSE, follow the steps below:
 - Time how long it takes a medium pizza to enter the oven all the way until it is on the heat rack. Begin the stopwatch as soon as it is placed on the oven belt, and stop the stopwatch after the pizza has exited the oven, been cut, boxed, and placed on the hot rock.
 - To change oven time in PULSE 3.9, visit Back Office Management → Setup → Store Parameters → Goals → Oven Time
 - If you need to adjust your oven time in a PULSE 4.0 Store, please reach out to NextGenStore@dominos.com
- **Where can I see the visit?**
 - Franchisees will be able to view the output of each visit on the Franchisee Portal in Connect under the "Store Visits" tab.
- **Can I expect to have an oven visit every year moving forward?**
 - DPZ is determining a future strategy based on the data collected through this first round of visits. Based on the opportunity identified by consumers, this is going to be a fundamental focus in the years ahead.
- **What about my Ops Assessment?**
 - The Ops Assessment team remains committed to ensuring every store receives at least one Operations Assessment this year. As in prior years, some stores may receive two or more assessments.